
Flower Dedication

The beautiful flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in celebration of Catherine Bennett Smith’s fifth birthday and Lillian James Smith’s second birthday in October. They are the daughters of Slater and Abby Smith. Alan and Gina Smith, Catherine’s and Lily’s grandparents, are so grateful for the continued blessings our God has bestowed on these precious little girls and their family. *“Let them thank the Lord for His steadfast love, for His wondrous works to the children of man!” — Psalm 107:8*

Announcements

Roca Blanca Project Fund. Our mission team needs help funding the work they will do while in Mexico. Giving to the RB Project Fund will go directly to purchasing food baskets for hungry people and buying supplies for all projects the team will complete while on the base. Envelopes are available at the Narthex and East Entrance. Thank you for participating in the work of the Lord at home and in other countries!

Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Clayton Stanley

Greeters — Dr. Ben & Allison Long

Acolytes — Sawyze Fisher & Blair Bryant

Circle of Prayer — Becky Stewart & Malachi Doren

Ushers — Trey Tull, Don Williams, Brent Johnson, Hack Smith, & Hayden Worsham

Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Bobby & Nicole Roach, Terre Smith, Rebecca Sawyer, & Courtney Taylor

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor

Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship

Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care

Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries

Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director

Jan Pike - Choir Director

Malachi Doren - Accompanist

Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant

Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

August 25 Women’s Bible Study — Youth House, 8 a.m.

August 27 MI3 Week 3

August 26 KidsQuest / Youth · Women’s Bible Study, 6 p.m.

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

August 23, 2026

Thirteenth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children’s Church during the service. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“*Restored by Grace: Shaped by the Word*”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 7:1–10

Ezra 7 introduces us to a man who understood something crucial: God’s Word isn’t given merely to be studied. It is given to shape us.

Have you ever noticed how easy it is to become an expert these days? If your sink starts leaking, you can watch a YouTube video and become convinced you can rebuild the entire plumbing system in your house. However, there is a difference between knowing something and being shaped by it. We live in a culture where information can fill our head without ever changing our life. That is really where Ezra 7 takes us. Ezra isn’t simply a man who knows God’s Word. Ezra is a man who has been shaped by God’s Word. That distinction matters, not only for Ezra, but for every one of us.

I. Know the Word (vv. 1–6)

Psalm 119:11 — “I have stored up your word in my heart, that I might not sin against you.”

II. Live the Word (v. 10a)

Deuteronomy 6:7 — “...talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise.”

III. Share the Word (v. 10b)

CHILDREN’S CHURCH
Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children’s Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.

*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

*Children Dismissed to Children’s Church

WORD

Scripture Reading

Ezra 7:1–10 · Pew Bible, p. 393

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.

Sermon: “Restored by Grace: Shaped by the Word”

Rev. Waring Porter

Prayer of Commitment

SENDING

HOW FIRM A FOUNDATION
Written in the late 18th century and based on the promises of Scripture, this hymn reminds us that God’s Word is a sure and unchanging foundation. It echoes Ezra 7, the call of Deuteronomy 6 to hear and treasure God’s Word, and Isaiah 40:8: “the word of our God will stand forever.”

*Hymn: #275

“How Firm a Foundation” (vv. 1–2)

*Benediction

*Choral Benediction

“Benediction” (2-part)

*Postlude

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

August 23, 2026

** Indicates congregation standing if able*

GATHERING

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: Psalm 119:10

“With my whole heart I seek you; let me not wander from your commandments!”

The Prelude

PRELUDE
The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God’s presence.

Choral Introit

“Blessed Assurance”

*Call to Worship: Psalm 119:9–16

Leader: How can a young man keep his way pure?

All: By guarding it according to your word.

Leader: With my whole heart I seek you;

All: Let me not wander from your commandments!

Leader: I have stored up your word in my heart,

All: That I might not sin against you.

Leader: I will meditate on your precepts

All: And fix my eyes on your ways.

Leader: I will delight in your statutes;

All: I will not forget your word.

Leader: Let us worship God, who has spoken and whose Word gives life.

*The Hymn: #269

“O Word of God Incarnate” (vv. 1–3)

CALL TO WORSHIP
We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God’s call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.

INVOCATION
The word “invocation” suggests that the congregation calls upon God, yet this must not be misunderstood to mean that we bring God into our presence or that His nearness depends on our request. The Lord is already present with His people before our worship begins. To “invoke” is to call upon or earnestly seek. So, we lift our voices to God, asking Him to draw near and enable us to worship Him rightly for His character and mighty works.

THE SHEMA: DEUT. 6:4–9
“Hear, O Israel...” — this foundational confession of Israel calls God’s people to love the Lord wholeheartedly and to faithfully treasure and teach His Word. It reminds us that God’s Word is not merely something we read on Sunday; it is truth to be stored in our hearts, lived in our homes, and woven into every part of our daily lives.

***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

***The Old Testament Reading:** Deuteronomy 6:1–9

“Now this is the commandment—the statutes and the rules—that the Lord your God commanded me to teach you, that you may do them in the land to which you are going over, to possess it, that you may fear the Lord your God, you and your son and your son’s son, by keeping all his statutes and his commandments, which I command you, all the days of your life, and that your days may be long. Hear therefore, O Israel, and be careful to do them, that it may go well with you, and that you may multiply greatly, as the Lord, the God of your fathers, has promised you, in a land flowing with milk and honey.

“Hear, O Israel: The Lord our God, the Lord is one. You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your might. And these words that I command you today shall be on your heart. You shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise. You shall bind them as a sign on your hand, and they shall be as frontlets between your eyes. You shall write them on the doorposts of your house and on your gates.”

***Congregational Response: #269**

O make Thy Church, dear Savior, a lamp of burnished gold, To bear before the nations Thy true light as of old. O teach Thy wand’ring pilgrims by this, their path to trace, Till, clouds and darkness ended, they see Thee face to face.

“O Word of God Incarnate” (v. 4)

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious and holy God, we confess that we have not loved You with all our heart, soul, mind, and strength. We have neglected Your Word, wandered from Your commands, and trusted our own wisdom rather than Your truth. We confess that we have often been slow to obey, slow to listen, and forgetful of the grace You have shown us. Forgive us, Lord. Give us hearts that hunger for Your Word and delight in Your ways. Teach us to treasure Your truth, to obey it faithfully, and to speak of it in our homes and throughout our daily lives. Shape us by Your Word, sanctify us by Your truth, and conform us more and more to the likeness of Christ. We ask this in the name of Jesus, our Savior and Redeemer.

Silent Confession

Assurance of Divine Pardon: John 17:17–19

“Sanctify them in the truth; your word is truth. As you sent me into the world, so I have sent them into the world. And for their sake I consecrate myself, that they also may be sanctified in truth.”

***Gloria Patri**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

***Profession of Faith:** The Apostles’ Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.*

**that is, the true Christian church of all times and all places*

Story of Grace

YH Student Retreat

Virginia Boyd James, Student Ministry Leader

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

Choral Anthem

“Lord, I Know I Been Changed”

Traditional Spiritual; arr. Larry Shackley

ASSURANCE OF PARDON

After confessing our sins, we hear God’s promise of forgiveness, reminding us that the good news of Jesus Christ meets our confession with grace. We are reminded that true repentance is always answered by God’s faithful forgiveness, and Christ’s saving work is greater than our sin.

THE APOSTLES’ CREED

The Apostles’ Creed is a concise summary of the Christian faith, affirming the Triune God — Father, Son, and Holy Spirit — and the redeeming work of Jesus Christ. It connects us with the historic church and provides a clear, biblical confession that strengthens our unity and directs our worship.